

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Page 47 - Morality Plays and Interludes

Q1. Who was a prominent humorous character introduced later into morality plays, often serving as the fun-maker?

- A. The Devil
- B. The Vice
- C. The Hero
- D. The King

Answer: B

Q2. The character of 'The Vice' is specially interesting as the direct forerunner of what later stage character?

- A. The tragic hero
- B. The Elizabethan stage clown
- C. The chorus
- D. The romantic lead

Answer: B

Q3. Why did the morality play have greater freedom in the handling of plot and characters than the miracle play?

- A. Because the church had no control over it
- B. Because it was not obliged to follow the prescribed lines of any given biblical story
- C. Because it was written exclusively for the king
- D. Because it was performed only by professional actors

Answer: B

Q4. During the Reformation period, what was the morality play often used for?

- A. Purely comedic entertainment
- B. Translating the Bible
- C. Purposes of exposition and religious controversy by both parties
- D. Training soldiers

Answer: C

Q5. As personified abstractions in morality plays began to resemble individual persons, what did the morality

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

play insensibly pass into?

- A. Tragedy
- B. Epic poetry
- C. Comedy
- D. History plays

Answer: C

Q6. What was the 'interlude'?

- A. A late product of the dramatic development of the morality play
- B. A long, serious religious epic
- C. A type of sonnet
- D. A musical performance without words

Answer: A

Q7. In its specific sense, what does the 'interlude' refer to?

- A. A purely religious sermon
- B. A short dramatic piece of a satiric character, far less serious than a morality play
- C. A tragedy based on Roman history
- D. A translation of a Greek play

Answer: B

Q8. Which name is closely associated with the growth of the interlude form in the early sixteenth century?

- A. Geoffrey Chaucer
- B. John Heywood
- C. Thomas Sackville
- D. Nicholas Udall

Answer: B

Q9. What is the title of John Heywood's most amusing interlude, featuring a Palmer, Pardoner, Potheary, and Pedlar?

- A. The Four Ps
- B. Roister Doister
- C. Everyman

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

D. Gorboduc

Answer: A

Q10. What is the climax of the competition in 'The Four Ps'?

A. A physical fight

B. A singing contest

C. A competition to see who can tell the biggest lie

D. A theological debate

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Page 48 - The Beginnings of Regular Comedy and Tragedy

Q1. Why are early experiments in play-writing (miracle/morality plays) historically important?

- A. They provided a kind of 'Dame School' for English dramatic genius, preparing the way for regular drama
- B. They were all written by Shakespeare
- C. They were the only literature allowed to be printed
- D. They completely destroyed classical literature

Answer: A

Q2. Under what direct influence did English comedy and tragedy pass into forms of art?

- A. The Norman Conquest
- B. The revival of learning
- C. The Industrial Revolution
- D. The discovery of America

Answer: B

Q3. From which classical playwrights did the Renaissance men initially take their models for comedy and tragedy?

- A. Greek playwrights like Sophocles
- B. Latin playwrights (Plautus, Terence, Seneca)
- C. Egyptian playwrights
- D. Early French playwrights

Answer: B

Q4. What is considered the first real English comedy?

- A. Gorboduc
- B. Roister Doister
- C. Everyman
- D. The Four Ps

Answer: B

Q5. Who wrote Roister Doister around 1550?

- A. Nicholas Udall, head master of Eton

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

- B. Thomas Sackville
- C. John Heywood
- D. William Shakespeare

Answer: A

Q6. How is Roister Doister structured?

- A. In blank verse without acts
- B. In riming couplets, divided into acts and scenes in the Latin style
- C. As a continuous prose narrative
- D. As a series of unrelated sonnets

Answer: B

Q7. What is considered the first real English tragedy?

- A. Hamlet
- B. Roister Doister
- C. Gorboduc (or Ferrex and Porrex)
- D. Everyman

Answer: C

Q8. Gorboduc is an almost pedantic effort to reproduce the forms and spirit of whose tragedy?

- A. Plautus's
- B. Seneca's
- C. Terence's
- D. Aristotle's

Answer: B

Q9. Who wrote the first English tragedy, Gorboduc?

- A. Nicholas Udall and John Heywood
- B. Thomas Sackville and Thomas Norton
- C. Geoffrey Chaucer and John Gower
- D. William Shakespeare and Christopher Marlowe

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Q10. What is an interesting poetic first regarding Gorboduc?

- A. It was the first play to use rhyme royal
- B. It was the first of our plays to use blank verse
- C. It was the first play written entirely in prose
- D. It was the first play to use alliteration

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Page 49 - Table of the Development of the Drama

Q1. According to the table, what was the first recorded dramatic performance in England?

- A. Gorboduc
- B. Ludus de S. Katherina
- C. Roister Doister
- D. The Four Ps

Answer: B

Q2. In what year was the Festival of Corpus Christi instituted, giving impulse to miracle plays?

- A. 1110
- B. 1264
- C. 1340
- D. 1485

Answer: B

Q3. During whose reign was the Festival of Corpus Christi instituted?

- A. Henry I
- B. Henry III
- C. Edward III
- D. Richard III

Answer: B

Q4. When did the York cycle of miracle plays originate?

- A. About 1340
- B. Middle of the 14th century
- C. 15th century
- D. 16th century

Answer: A

Q5. When did the Wakefield cycle of miracle plays originate?

- A. About 1340
- B. Middle of the 14th century

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

C. Middle of the 15th century

D. Early 16th century

Answer: C

Q6. What is the earliest extant morality play listed in the table?

A. Everyman

B. The Castell of Perseverance

C. Lusty Juventus

D. Roister Doister

Answer: B

Q7. When did interludes begin to appear according to the table?

A. 13th century

B. 14th century

C. Early 16th century

D. Late 16th century

Answer: C

Q8. In what year was Gorboduc written?

A. 1520

B. 1550

C. 1561

D. 1566

Answer: C

Q9. What was the second English comedy, written in 1566 by John Still?

A. Roister Doister

B. Gammer Gurton's Needle

C. The Four Ps

D. Everyman

Answer: B

Q10. Based on the footnote, what is the accepted English term for religious drama, despite continental

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

distinctions between 'mysteries' and 'miracle plays'?

- A. Morality Play
- B. Miracle Play
- C. Interlude
- D. Mystery Play

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Page 50 - The Age of Shakespeare (Part 1)

Q1. What period of time does the 'Shakespearean Age' broadly cover?

- A. The entire 15th century
- B. From the Norman Conquest to the Black Death
- C. From the accession of Elizabeth in 1558 to the death of James I in 1625
- D. The reign of Queen Victoria

Answer: C

Q2. The Shakespearean Age is described as falling naturally into how many divisions?

- A. Two
- B. Three
- C. Four
- D. Five

Answer: B

Q3. How is the first division (the first 21 years of the Queen's reign) characterized?

- A. The time of decline (autumn)
- B. The time of preparation, or the springtide of Elizabethan literature
- C. The time of full fruition (summer)
- D. The dark ages

Answer: B

Q4. How is the second division (between Spenser's Shepheardes Calender and Elizabeth's death) characterized?

- A. The time of preparation
- B. The time of full fruition, or summer
- C. The time of decline
- D. The time of religious war

Answer: B

Q5. How is the third division (the 22 years of the reign of James I) characterized?

- A. The springtide of literature

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

- B. The time of full fruition
- C. Its time of decline, or autumn
- D. The rebirth of classical literature

Answer: C

Q6. Strictly speaking, what is the proper designation for the third division of this period?

- A. Elizabethan
- B. Jacobean
- C. Tudor
- D. Victorian

Answer: B

Q7. Why is the entire period referred to collectively as the Age of Shakespeare?

- A. Because Shakespeare ruled England
- B. Because of literary development reasons, including both Elizabethan and Jacobean eras
- C. Because no other authors lived during this time
- D. Because Shakespeare invented the printing press

Answer: B

Q8. How does this period rank in the annals of the world's literature?

- A. As the most barren and unproductive
- B. As completely average
- C. As one of the greatest, due to its fertility, variety, and splendor
- D. As solely focused on scientific achievements

Answer: C

Q9. What happened to the 'average mood' of the nation during this period?

- A. It was sluggish and dull
- B. It was exceptionally vigorous and alert
- C. It was deeply mournful
- D. It was entirely apathetic

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Q10. Which authors are mentioned as growing from boyhood into youth during the early years of Elizabeth's reign?

- A. Chaucer, Gower, Langland
- B. Spenser, Bacon, and Shakespeare
- C. Wyatt, Surrey, and Udall
- D. Milton, Dryden, and Pope

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Page 51 - The Age of Shakespeare (Part 2)

Q1. How did the revival of learning affect the general public during this era?

- A. It remained limited to the scholarly few at universities
- B. Innumerable translations carried classic treasures far and wide to a large miscellaneous public
- C. It was banned by the Queen
- D. Only French literature was translated

Answer: B

Q2. What quote is used to describe the pervasive influence of classical literature in England?

- A. 'Every breeze was dusty with the pollen of Greece, Rome, and of Italy'
- B. 'The sun never sets on the English empire'
- C. 'To be or not to be'
- D. 'Knowledge is power'

Answer: A

Q3. While the Renaissance aroused the intellect and aesthetic faculties, what did the Reformation awaken?

- A. Military strategy
- B. Industrial production
- C. The spiritual nature
- D. The desire for foreign conquest

Answer: C

Q4. What significant religious text did the printing press put into the hands of the people?

- A. The Latin Vulgate
- B. The English Bible
- C. The Book of Common Prayer
- D. The 95 Theses

Answer: B

Q5. What effect did the discovery of new worlds and explorers' tales have on the English mind?

- A. It caused intense fear and isolationism
- B. It quickened popular curiosity, zest of adventure, and enlarged the boundaries of men's minds

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

- C. It led to an immediate ban on all sailing
- D. It made people lose interest in literature

Answer: B

Q6. Which of the following is NOT listed as a daring explorer of the time?

- A. Hawkins
- B. Drake
- C. Columbus
- D. Frobisher

Answer: C

Q7. What was the state of the country's internal affairs for the first time in many years?

- A. It was engaged in a civil war
- B. It enjoyed the blessing of internal peace
- C. It was suffering a terrible famine
- D. It was constantly changing monarchs

Answer: B

Q8. How did the fierce feuds of Catholic and Protestant change during this period?

- A. They intensified into open warfare
- B. The feuds were now over, and discordant elements were welded into a united nation
- C. The country split into two separate kingdoms
- D. Protestantism was outlawed

Answer: B

Q9. What crisis imperiled England's existence but ultimately caused Englishmen to sink minor differences and stand shoulder to shoulder?

- A. The Black Death
- B. The invasion of the Vikings
- C. The collision with Spain (The Spanish Armada)
- D. The French Revolution

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 10)

Q10. What became one of the outstanding features of the age as a result of defending against a common foe?

- A. Intense patriotism
- B. Widespread cowardice
- C. A desire to emigrate
- D. Religious despair

Answer: A